



Security for real people

Lock down Android before trouble finds you

Android security does not have to be dramatic. For most users, including the average Indian user carrying banking apps, UPI, Aadhaar PDFs, PAN scans, office email, family photos and years of WhatsApp history, security is not about becoming paranoid. It is about making the phone boringly difficult to misuse, steal, unlock, scam or infect. A secure phone is not a fortress with barbed wire. It is a house with proper locks, working lights, labelled keys and an emergency plan.

The threats are also more ordinary than people think. A stolen phone in a market. A fake APK forwarded on

WhatsApp. A “customer care” scammer asking you to install a screen-sharing app. A phishing link pretending to update KYC. A child approving a random permission. A phone left unlocked at a service centre. A UPI collect request disguised as a refund. These are not elite cyberattacks. They are everyday traps.

Start with the lock screen

Your first security layer is still the lock screen. Not the antivirus app. Not the scary warning message. The humble PIN, password, pattern, fingerprint or face unlock.